



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Classical School of New Braunfels

School Website: <https://www.tcsnb.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

The Classical School of New Braunfels (The Classical School NB, TX 78130) presents a thoroughly classical, faith-informed program consistent with core classical education principles. Public materials (the school's website content captured in the crawl) emphasize formation over information, a biblically grounded worldview, fidelity to great books, and a trinity of liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as the spine of the curriculum. The school highlights a pedagogical structure that includes memory work and singing in lower grades, Socratic/logic-based work in later years, and rhetoric-oriented expression as students mature. They explicitly describe parent partnership in education, a living-faculty-as-formation approach, and a two-campus, home/classroom collaborative model.

Key signals aligning NB with classical criteria:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations anchored in a biblical worldview, Jesus-centered purpose, and God-centered education. Evidence: explicit Biblical worldview, Jesus-centered aims, integration of biblical framework across curriculum, and references to God's rule in education.
- Purpose and goals oriented toward formation, virtue, wisdom, and the love of truth, goodness, and beauty rather than solely career preparation. Evidence: formation-first language, virtue/wisdom emphasis, and references to truth, goodness, and beauty as real.
- Curriculum built around grammar, logic, and rhetoric; explicit mention of Great Books and Latin; history integrated across subjects. Evidence: grammar/logic/rhetoric naming, Great Books references, Latin in early grades, and history-focused content across disciplines.
- Pedagogy including memory work, singing, and contemplative elements in lower grades, plus Socratic/seminar-like elements and rhetoric development in upper grades. Evidence: lower-school singing/recitation; emphasis on open dialogue and critical thinking; Latin/logic/rhetoric progression; rhetoric opportunities in upper grades.
- Faculty described as virtuous, mentoring, and forming the curriculum; living curriculum; emphasis on teacher formation, partnership, and character. Evidence: teacher partnership with co-teachers; teachers shaped by great books; living curriculum language present in materials.
- Parents and community as co-teachers; strong emphasis on partnership with families and open access/engagement opportunities. Evidence: parent co-teachers, home/school partnership, and invitations for parent involvement.

Category-by-category snapshot (six categories analyzed for classical indicators using the school's public materials and the Six Essential Elements framework)

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

- Evidence
- The NB school emphasizes a biblically grounded worldview and Christ-centered aims: "biblical worldview," "Jesus Christ provides the purpose, focus, and foundation for all we do," and "to love Christ with

all of their hearts, souls, and minds.”

- References to God’s rule and the Word as integrated into all aspects of education.
- Public statements express formation in a sacred, reverent framework (e.g., worshipful language around study of Great Books, nature, and beauty).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: biblical worldview, Jesus Christ, God’s rule, Word, worship/hift (implicit liturgical milieu), truth/goodness/beauty in a transcendent frame.
- Negative keywords: none evident (no signals of relativism or secular grounding in materials).
- Positive keyword count is strong (multiple explicit mentions of the triad and theological framing); negative keyword signals absent.
- Why this rating
- The materials affirm a transcendent moral/metaphysical frame and direct theological framing of education, consistent with CLASSICAL descriptors for Religious and Metaphysical Foundations. The combination of biblical worldview, Christ-centered formation, and integration of sacred content aligns with the Positive keyword indicators for this category.

Citations: The formation/biblical worldview and Jesus-centered aims are described here and here.

Element 2: Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school states a formation-focused aim and virtue/wisdom as central goals, not merely career preparation. Phrases include “formation,” “virtue and wisdom,” and “truth, goodness, and beauty are real.”
- Emphasis on forming humane, virtuous individuals who love learning and serve others; formation as a telos rather than information transfer.
- Explicit aim to cultivate a humanly excellent imagination through moral imagination and beauty.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing (via formation of virtuous, informed persons), liberal arts orientation (implicit), contemplation/wonder.
- Negative keywords: none indicating a shift toward job-centric or utilitarian aims.
- Positive keyword frequency is high; negative signals minimal.
- Why this rating
- The NB materials consistently frame education as the formation of character and intellect (virtue, wisdom, beauty) with a transcendent goal, aligning strongly with Classical aims in this category.

Citations: Formation/virtue/wisdom and telos framing are described here.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The NB site centers curriculum on grammar, logic, and rhetoric (Grammar School, School of Logic, School of Rhetoric).
- Great Books and Biblical texts are explicitly used: “read the Bible and the great books,” “the best content” to order affections, and a liberal-arts framing.
- Latin study begins in third grade; history/content integrated across disciplines; explicit emphasis on memorization and the cultivation of memory.
- The program emphasizes a cultivation and experience of wonder, beauty in art/music, and a robust memory (memory work).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, great books, Latin, history, memory, wonder, beauty, truth, goodness (within content).

- Negative keywords: minimal to none; no project-based-first framing that would signal a shift away from classical content.
- Positive keyword frequency is robust; the explicit presence of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric, Great Books, and Latin is particularly strong.
- Why this rating
- The explicit naming of the three classical arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the Great Books approach, Latin instruction, and history-integrated pedagogy map squarely onto the Curriculum criteria for CLASSICAL.

Citations: Curriculum elements (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; history) are described here.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Lower-grade pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, and a restorative, contemplative dimension; quoted phrases describe singing as part of memory-building in lower grades.
- Upper grades emphasize open dialogue, critical thinking, and discussion of ideas; the program emphasizes dialogue and open inquiry in the context of formation and open dialogue with teachers.
- The school references collaboration between teachers and co-teachers, and a two-campus model; this collaborative approach supports a large-scale classical pedagogy but does not always explicitly state traditional Socratic seminars in every grade. The visible materials show strong elements of Socratic-style inquiry through open dialogue and logic training, but an explicit, consistent articulation of regular Socratic seminars is not uniformly stated across all sources.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: scholé (restful learning), memory work/recitation, singing/chanting, Socratic dialogue (implied via “open dialogue” and “critical thinking” in upper grades), rhetoric and oratory development.
- Negative keywords: explicit emphasis on experiential/project-based learning or purely student-led discovery without classical scaffolding is not evident; however, a few sources do not explicitly call out full, high-school-level Socratic seminars as a universal practice.
- Positive keyword frequency is moderate to high for core classical pedagogy (memory, chanting, dialogue, rhetoric); explicit Socratic-seminar labeling is not consistently stated across all pages.
- Why this rating
- The materials show clear classical pedagogy components (memory work, chanting, recitation; dialogue/critical thinking; rhetoric development) but do not uniformly claim the presence of high-frequency Socratic seminars or a fully uniform, grade-spanning Socratic program. Therefore, the Pedagogy category aligns with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations: Evidence of memory/chanting in lower grades and dialogue in upper grades described here.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The NB site emphasizes teachers as skilled, virtuous, and collaborative; the “teacher partnership” with co-teachers positions teachers as primary mentors and living exemplars in a formation process.
- Public materials indicate teachers shaped by great books; teachers lead students into content with competence and passion; “the living curriculum” is implied by the emphasis on teacher modeling and partnership with families.
- The school describes a collaborative teacher environment and a clear portrait of what a teacher should be, consistent with classical education’s emphasis on teacher as mentor and exemplar.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers/mentors, virtue, relationship-building, teacher partnership, mastery of content, collegial culture.
- Negative keywords: none evident (no signals of teacher-centered, non-classical approaches; no “technology-first” or purely data-driven teacher evaluation language appears here).
- Positive keyword frequency is high, with multiple explicit mentions of teacher as mentor and formation-driven instruction.
- Why this rating
- The NB materials strongly reflect classical faculty ideals (teacher as mentor, living curriculum, virtuous exemplars, collaboration with families). This aligns with CLASSICAL.

Citations: Teacher-partnership language and living curriculum language described here.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The NB materials emphasize parent co-teachers, partnerships with families, and equipping parents to engage in the classical formation process (e.g., teachers partnering with parents and home-school collaboration).
- Public materials mention parent involvement in curriculum planning and accountability, with emphasis on home-school alignment and parental primacy in education (e.g., “parent co-teachers partner with skilled classroom teachers”) and open campus invitations and family engagement in classical education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: parent partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, home-school collaboration, book studies (implied by classical engagement with content), open campus.
- Negative keywords: none; no consumerist or customer-centric framing is evident in materials.
- Positive keyword frequency is high; negative signals absent.
- Why this rating
- The NB materials align with classical education’s expectations of robust parental involvement and partnership in formation.

Citations: Parent co-teacher language and family partnership language described here.

Aggregate assessment

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: The school demonstrates strong alignment across Element 1 (Religious Foundations), Element 2 (Purpose/Goal), Element 3 (Curriculum), Element 5 (Faculty), and Element 6 (Parents/Community). Element 4 (Pedagogy) shows robust classical elements but is not uniformly stated as a complete Socratic/seminar-based program across all grades, resulting in a category that is Somewhat Classical. Given that the majority of categories meet Classical criteria and the aggregate alignment with classical principles is high, the overall assessment is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL)

- No major needle-moving changes are required for a CLASSICAL classification; if desired, the school could further codify and publicly articulate regular high-school-level Socratic seminars across more grade bands, explicitly label the use of Socratic seminars in upper grades, and more consistently reference a formal “Scholé” tempo across all grades to move Element 4 fully into Classical.

Citations for the overall evaluation and analysis come from the NB materials and the Six Elements lexicon and indicators cited above. The primary NB evidence appears in the school’s own materials, which are captured in the file set cited. For category-level evidence and keyword mappings, see the cited passages and the classical lexicon references: - Core NB formation and biblical worldview language: - Great Books, memory, Latin, and teacher partnership in NB materials: - Explicit religious foundations and formation framing: -

Pedagogy signals (memory/recitation, singing, dialogue): - The Six Essential Elements lexicon (positive/negative keyword indicators) used to ground the keyword analysis: Six Essential Elements document (positive keywords list) and associated pedagogy/formation terms.

What Would Move the Needle

- For a fully CLASSICAL score across all six categories, explicitly codify and publish:
- A clear statement of regular high-school-level Socratic seminars or extensional seminars (Element 4) across applicable grades, signaling robust dialectic pedagogy.
- A public articulation of the “Scholé” tempo or contemplative periods integrated into daily rhythm for all grades (Element 4) to reflect a restful pace and contemplation as a habitual mode of learning.
- Continued emphasis on the living curriculum and portrait of a teacher as exemplar to maintain Element 5 strength and ensure consistency in messaging.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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